

Running Windows apps on other operating systems require the app to be binary compatible. Only binary compatible apps can run on multiple hardware and OSes. However, since Windows apps are not compatible with UNIX, you cannot run them on FreeBSD, a UNIX-based system. Hence, to run Windows apps on FreeBSD, you will have to install WINE. Short for Wine Is Not an Emulator, WINE is a software that can help you make Windows apps compatible with other systems, including FreeBSD.

Prerequisites and what you will learn

This chapter will help you learn everything about installing and using WINE on FreeBSD to run Windows apps. You will also learn how to install GUI helpers for WINE and the best tips to use them. It will help if you have a working knowledge of UNIX and FreeBSD, how to install FreeBSD, and install third-party applications on FreeBSD.

An overview of WINE

As mentioned, the WINE system acts as a compatibility layer that allows you to run Windows apps on other operating systems. When installed on OSes like FreeBSD, WINE can intercept system calls and translate them to system-specific needs. For instance, it collects and translates Windows calls to FreeBSD calls to understand the command and execute the result accordingly. It will then translate the results given by FreeBSD so that the Windows app can understand them.



Installing and using Unix-based FreeBSD.